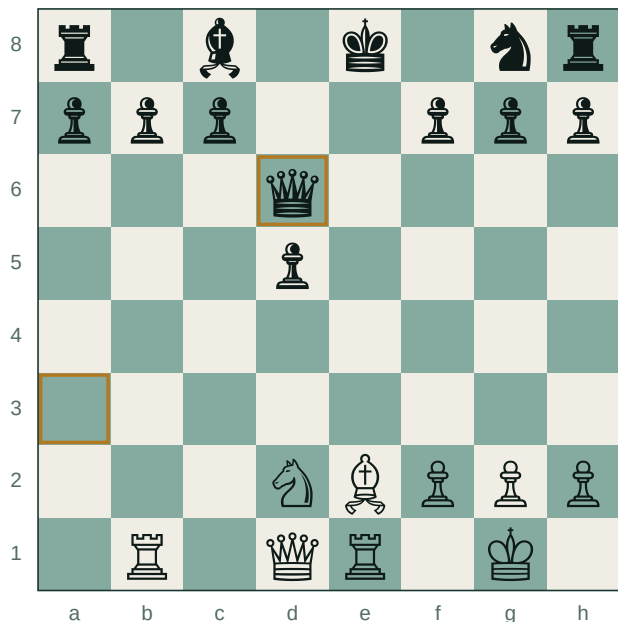


# Double checks: White, move 16

Double checks

White to move



Previous move: 15...Qd6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**16. Bb5+ Kf8 17. Re8#**

**16.Bb5+** Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. The changed line means the rook on e1 attacks the king on e8. Recorded reply: **16...Kf8**.

**17.Re8#** Mate: rook on e8 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on f8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

**CHECKPOINT**

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on e8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

Double check is forcing, but not necessarily winning. The king may escape to safety if the follow-up is missing.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

Double check attacks the king with two pieces at once. The defender must move the king, so an ordinary block or capture of just one checker cannot solve the problem.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Locate the slider that can be uncovered and a checking destination for its blocker. Then calculate the king's legal escapes.

The defending king is on e8. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8 and rook on a8. Check for tactical protection.